PARSEC X

A MICRO 4X SPACE EMPIRE GAME
BY TODD SANDERS

This game, for 2 to 4 players, is a micro-simulation Space Empire game. The winning player is the one who is able to conquer, ally with, and maintain control of 4 different planets within the parsec boundaries of System X.

Needed to Play:

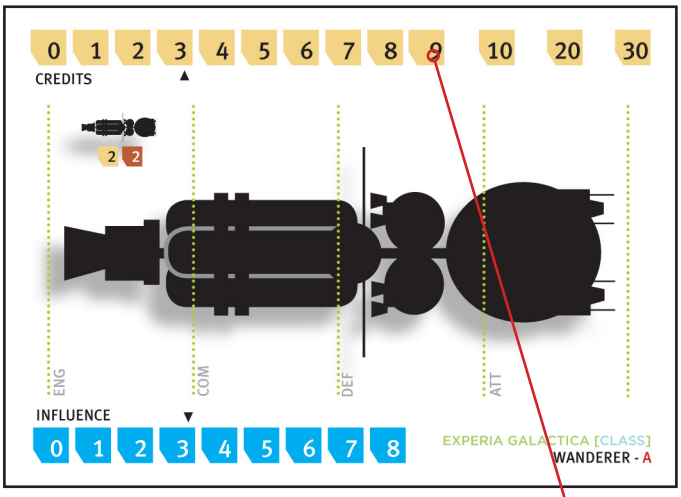
The 24 cards (4 Sector Map Cards, 8 Civilization Cards, 4 Ship and 4 Tech Tree Cards and 4 Encounter Cards), 15 eurocubes in each of 4 player colors (red, yellow, green and blue), 3 Civilization Markers per player in matching player colors, 8 black and 8 white eurocubes for planetary moons, and 10 six-sided dice.

Game Setup:

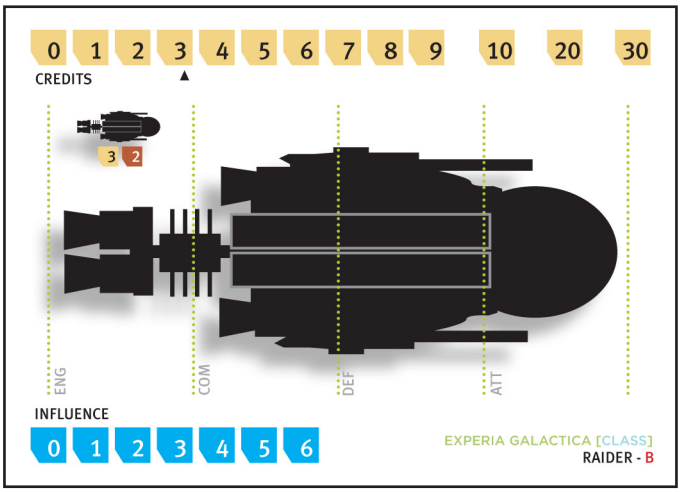
Each player receives one double sided Ship Card and Tech Tree Card. Players may choose which ship type they will use in the game.

The **Wanderer** is easier to upgrade but weaker in terms of defense and attack. The ship also gives you more Influence Resource capacity.

The **Raider** is more expensive to upgrade but is a stronger defense and attack ship in combat.



Ship Card

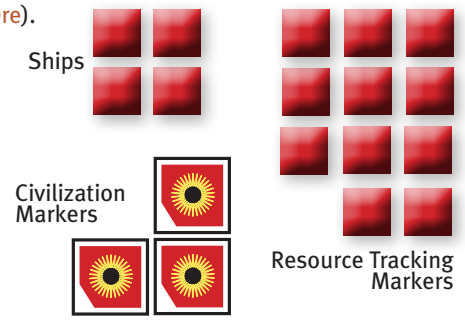


Tech Tree Card

Each card displays a series of horizontal tracks for your resources (Credits, Influence, Energy and Ore). The Ship Card shows the cost to build additional ships in the upper left and is divided into four sections which correspond on the Tech Tree Card to: Engines (ENG) [movement], Command (COM) [ability to affect die rolls during the game], Shields (DEF) and Weapons (ATT) [used in combat].

The Tech Tree Card shows your tech achievements and a cost in Resources to gain new upgrades.

Each player receives 15 wooden cubes in their player color (eleven of these are used on the resource tracks and for tech upgrades, the other four are used as a player's ships in the game) **and three colored Civilization markers to show which planets are under that player's control.**

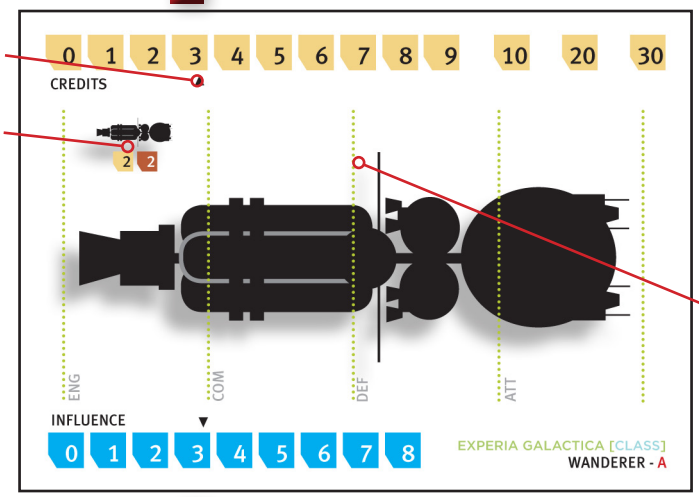


Ship Cards and Tech Tree Cards

Place a wooden cube next to each of the indicated starting resources icons (►)
Track gained and lost resources with these cubes as the game progresses

Starting resources icon

The cost in resources to build additional ships



SHIP CARD

A Ship Card is divided into four sections which correspond on the Tech Tree Card to:

Engines (ENG) [movement]

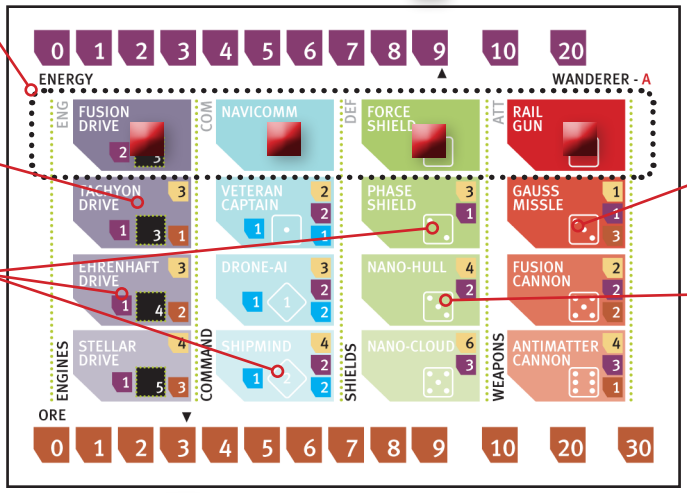
Command (COM) [ability to affect die rolls during the game]

Shields (DEF) and Weapons (ATT) [used in combat]

Place a wooden cube on each of these initial tech achievements

During the **Upgrade** Phase of each round a player may gain new technical achievements by spending the indicated cost in resources

The icons to the left of the resource costs show either the cost to use that particular achievement and/or modify a die roll during the game. All player's ships will share these achievements.



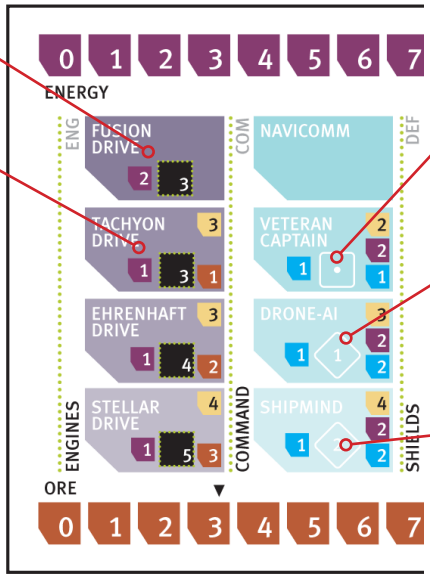
TECH TREE CARD

Number to add to a combat attack roll

Number to add to a combat defense roll

To move one ship up to 3 orthogonal sectors during the **Movement** Phase a player must spend 2 Energy Resources

Later achievements will allow a player to spend fewer Energy Resources to travel across more sectors



The VETERAN CAPTAIN lets a player spend 1 Influence Resource to add +1 to a die roll during the **Encounter** Phase

The DRONE-AI lets a player spend 1 Influence Resource to reroll a die of theirs during the **Encounter** Phase. **The player must accept the 2nd value rolled**

The SHIPMIND lets a player spend 1 Influence Resource to reroll a die of theirs twice during the **Encounter** Phase. **The player may accept any value rolled**

Sector Map Cards

A Sector Map Card is given to each player and they should be oriented depending on the number of players as shown in the diagrams below.

The cards are double sided and it is suggested that players choose side A when first playing the game.

Each player then places 2 wooden cubes on their Homeworld as their starting fleet of ships and keeps two more cubes in reserve.

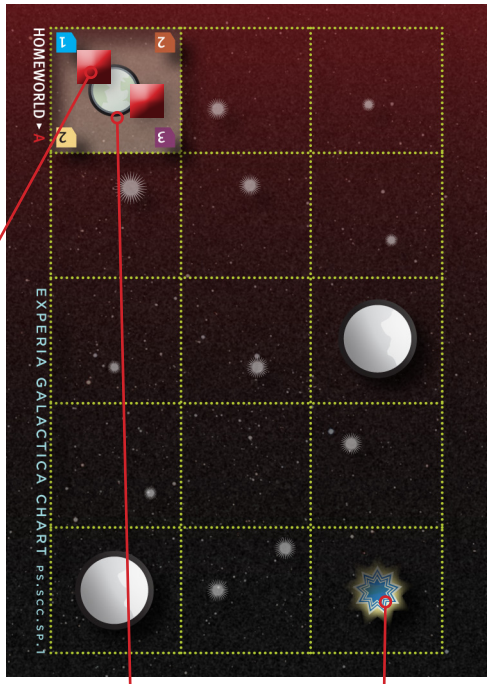
During the **Upkeep** Phase players may gain 2 of the 4 listed resources (they choose which) from their Homeworld.

As planets are explored and controlled by players they will gain additional resources.

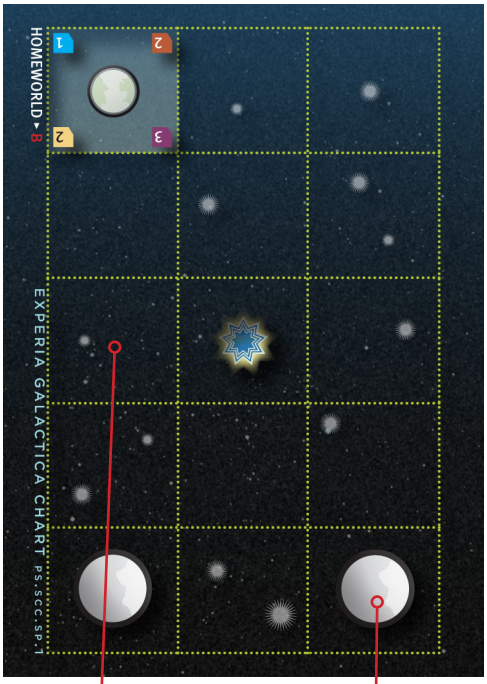
Players move their ships during the **Movement** Phase. They may only move a ship orthogonally, never diagonally, across the sector spaces on the map. Moving ships costs Energy Resources as indicated on a player's Tech Tree Card.

During the **Movement** Phase a player may move one or more ships through the Spacewarp: one Sector card clockwise or counterclockwise.

Sector Map Card - Side A



Sector Map Card - Side B

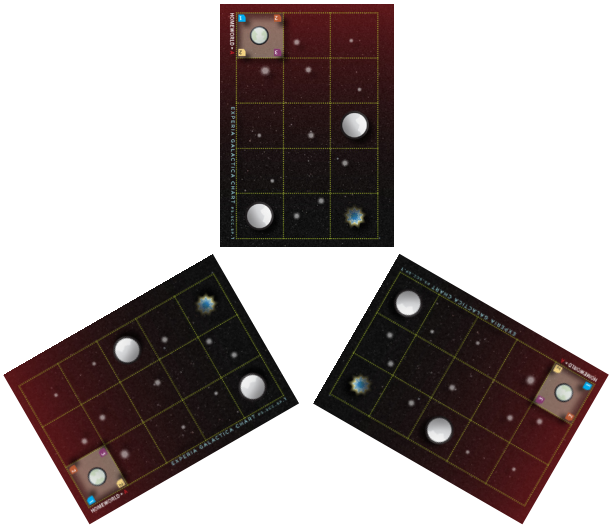


A Player's Homeworld: Resources able to be chosen during the Upkeep Phase are indicated in the corners of this sector

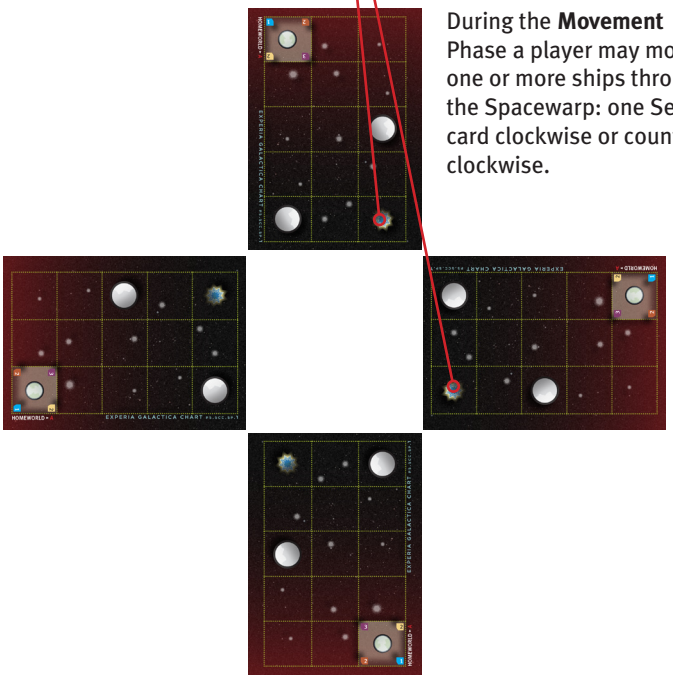
Spacewarp Icon: allows a player to send ships to other Sector Map Cards

sector space

Unknown Planet Icon: Unknown planets waiting to be explored during the **Encounter** Phase



Sector Map Card placement for a 2 player game



During the **Movement** Phase a player may move one or more ships through the Spacewarp: one Sector card clockwise or counter clockwise.

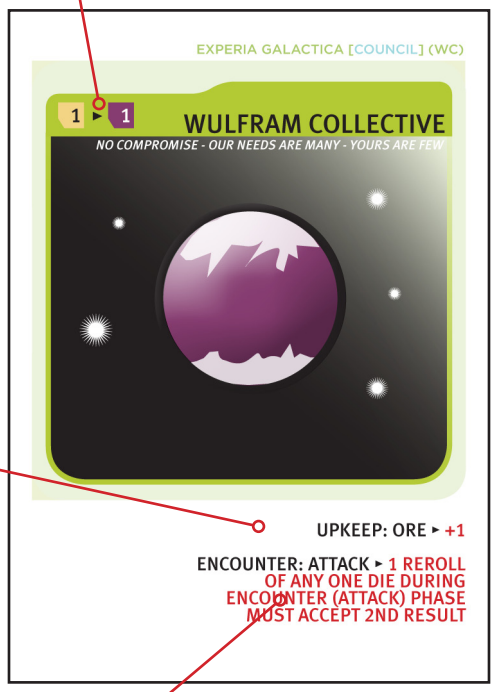
Sector Map Card placement for a 3 or 4 player game

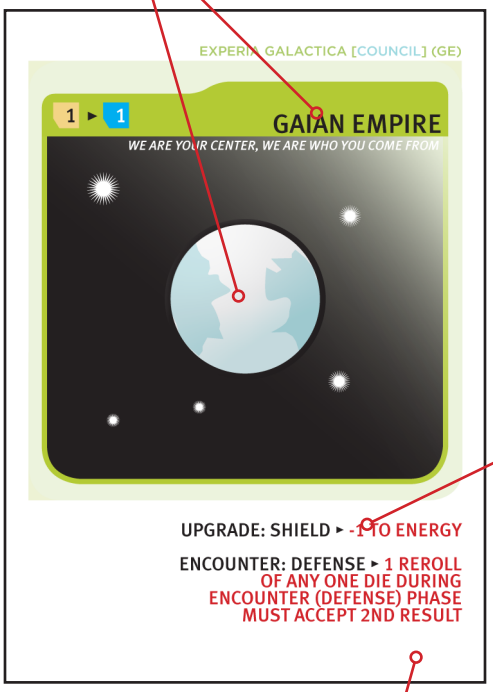
Civilization Cards

There are 8 Civilization Cards. Each shows one of the 8 civilizations that make up the Galactic Council. **Each player receives two of these cards randomly and may choose one of the Civilizations, discarding the other**. A Civilization gives a player certain bonuses in the game.

Each Civilization allows the player to convert one type of resource into another [*example: Credits into Energy*]. This is a one way conversion

The Civilization's name and an image of their Homeworld



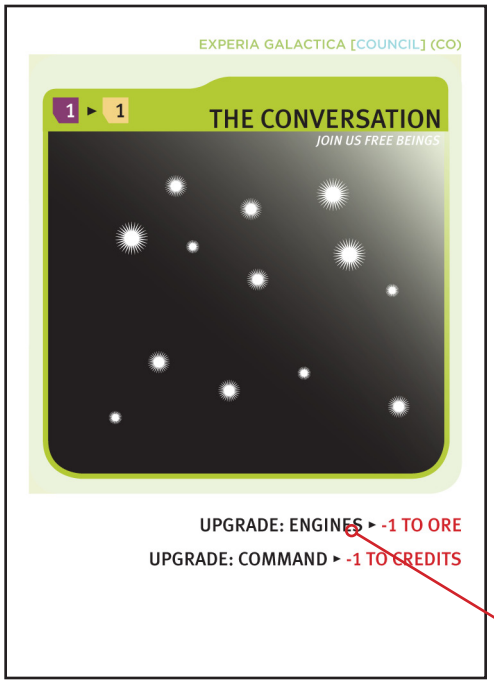


If this Civilization gains Ore during an **Upkeep** Phase, the player may gain one additional Ore Resource

During the **Upgrade** Phase, Shields cost one less Energy Resource for the player

During the **Encounter** Phase, the player may reroll one die if they are attacking in combat

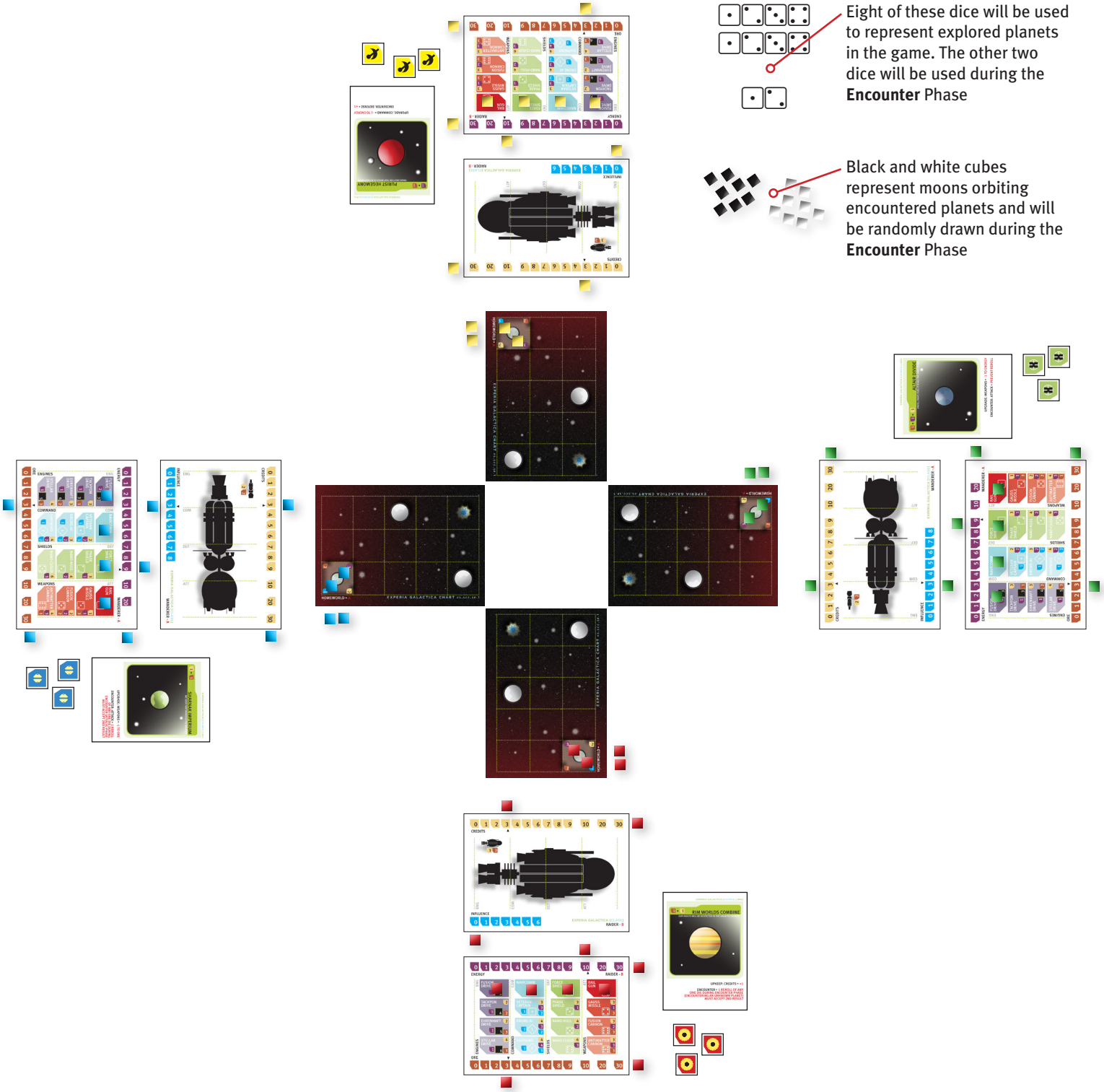
During the **Encounter** Phase, the player may reroll their die if they are defending in combat



During the **Upgrade** Phase, Engines cost one less Ore Resource for the player

Sample Game Start

This is an example game diagram for the start of a 4 player game. **Place the 10 dice, and 8 white and black cubes, within reach of all players.**



Players choose a Start Player however they wish and begin the game...

the four phases

upkeep
renew your resources

upgrade
spawn new ships
gain new tech

movement
displace your forces

encounter
explore planets
combat other civilizations

There are four phases in each round of the game. Players execute Phases 1 and 2 simultaneously and 3 and 4 in clockwise order beginning with the Start Player (The Start Player will call out each of the Phases in turn and make sure all players have completed each Phase). **The first player to control four Planets at the end of a round's Phase 4 is the winner.**

At the end of each round, the next player clockwise becomes the new Start Player and will call out the Phases.

the four phases

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Phase 1: UPKEEP - **Players execute this Phase simultaneously.**

During this Phase players gain resources from their Homeworld and any Planets and Colony moons they control. They track these accordingly on their Ship and Tech Tree Cards. For their Homeworld, a player may choose any 2 types of the 4 listed resources (2 Credits, 1 Influence, 3 Energy and 2 Ore) [*examples: a player may choose 2 Ore and 2 Credit Resources, 1 Influence and 2 Credit Resources, or 3 Energy and 2 Ore Resources*]

For any planets a player has encountered, and now controls, they may gain two of the specific resource of that planet [*example a Farm World produces 2 Credit Resources*] or 1 Influence Resource. They may not gain both.

For any planets that have a Colony Moon, the player may gain 1 additional Influence Resource.

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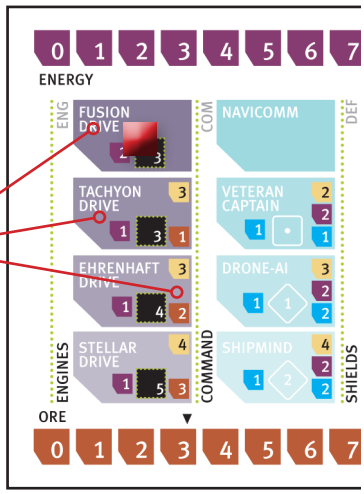
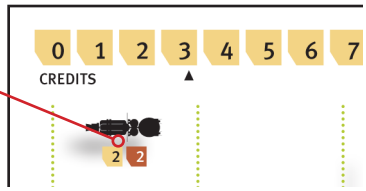
Phase 2: UPGRADE - **Players execute this Phase simultaneously.**

During this Phase players may gain new technical achievements by spending the indicated cost in resources shown to the right of the tech achievement. Move the wooden marker to the newly purchased achievement. A player may buy more than one achievement during this Phase. If buying multiple achievements in the same column [*example: upgrading from the Engines: Fusion Drive to Tachyon Drive to Ehrenhaft Drive*] at the same time, the cost for each upgrade must be paid in resources. A player may never skip over an achievement in any Tech Tree column without paying for it.



Each Civilization allows the player to convert one type of resource into another [*example: Credits into Energy*] to pay for these Upgrade costs as needed.

Players may also buy additional ships in this Phase. The cost of a new ship is shown in the upper left of the Ship Card. Pay the indicated resources and place the new ship either on the player's Homeworld or on a Shipyard Moon, if the player controls one. A player may never have more than four ships at any time.



the four phases

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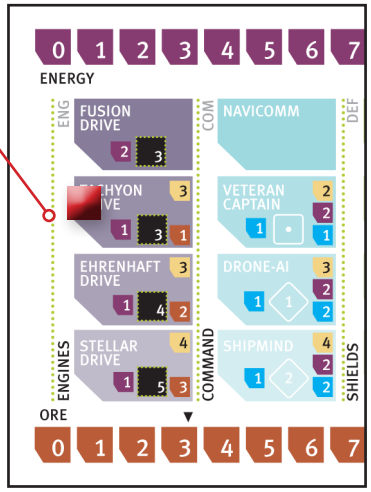
Phase 3: MOVEMENT - **Players execute this phase in clockwise order beginning with the current Start Player.**

Players may now move their ships based on their current level of Engine technology. In the example image, the player has a *Tachyon Drive*. This allows them to move one ship up to 3 orthogonal sectors by paying one Energy Resource. Players may move as many ships as far as they like as long as they can pay with the Energy Resources. A player may move fewer than the full number of sectors if they choose. Players may only move orthogonally, never diagonally. If a player places a ship on a Spacewarp icon they may place that ship on another Spacewarp icon of their choice one sector clockwise or counterclockwise without spending any extra Energy Resources.

To move to another Spacewarp, the player must wait until the next **Movement** Phase.

For the purposes of Phase 4, if a player's ship moves onto a space occupied by another player's ships or controlled planet, the moving player will be the *Attacker* during Phase 4 - Encounter: Combat.



the four phases

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Phase 4: ENCOUNTER - **Players execute this phase in clockwise order beginning with the current Start Player.**

A. Encountering an Unknown Planet

Note: Refer to the Encounter Cards explanation on the next page for further explanations of each Encounter type.

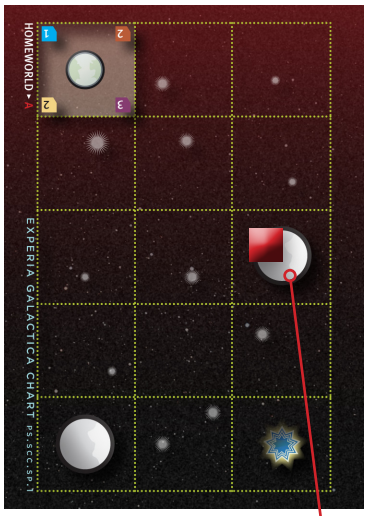
If a player has placed a ship on a sector with an Unknown Planet Icon, they may roll one die to determine the planetary type. The die is then placed with the number rolled face up on top of the Unknown Planet icon. If the number rolled is a ⚀, ⚁ or ⚂, the player may pay the settlement cost in resources and place one of their Civilization Markers under the die to show they control the planet. Once claimed, the player receives the resources of that planet during the **Upkeep** Phase.

If a ⚃ is rolled, the player has encountered a Xenophobic Empire and must attack the planet in Combat. If successful, the player may roll one die for the planetary type and place a Civilization Marker under the die (rotated to the correct planetary type) to show they control the planet. A random cube is drawn (white or black) and placed next to the planetary die as a moon. A white cube is a Colony and gives the player one Influence Resource during the **Upkeep** Phase. A black cube is a Shipyard and will allow the player to build ships here, in addition to their Homeworld during the **Upgrade** Phase.

If the player is unsuccessful in their attack, or there is a tie in the roll, the player's ship is lost and the die is placed on the sector with a ⚃ side facing up. Any player may encounter the Xenophobic Empire in a later round and attempt to control it in Combat.

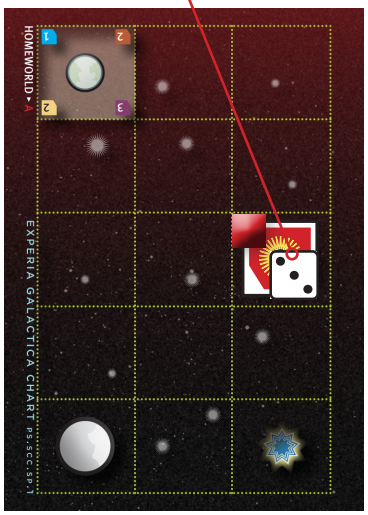
If a ⚄ is rolled, the player has encountered an Elder Civilization. They may attempt to use Influence to forge a Diplomatic Alliance with this Civilization. If successful, the player may roll one die for the planetary type and place a Civilization Marker under the die (rotated to the correct planetary type) to show they control the planet. No moons will be placed with this Encounter type.

If a player is unsuccessful or there is a tie in the roll while forging a Diplomatic Alliance, the planet die is placed with the ⚄ side of the die facing up and the player loses 1 Influence Resource if they have any. The player's ship remains on the sector. Any player may encounter the Elder Civilization in a later round and attempt to control it through Diplomatic Alliance.



The red player has placed one of his ships on an Unknown Planet. He rolls one die and determines it is a ⚄ Jovian World.

He pays 3 Ore Resources to settle the world and places one of his Civilization Markers under the die to claim control.



Encounter Cards

The four Encounter cards are used during the Encounter Phase to determine what type of planet is encountered.

When an unknown planet is encountered the player rolls one die and consults the Planetary Atlas to determine the Planetary Type. A roll of a ⚀ determines the planet is a Mining World, ⚁ - a Farming World, ⚂ - a Jovian World. if a ⚃, ⚄ or ⚅ is rolled, the player consults one of the other Encounter Cards to determine what to do.

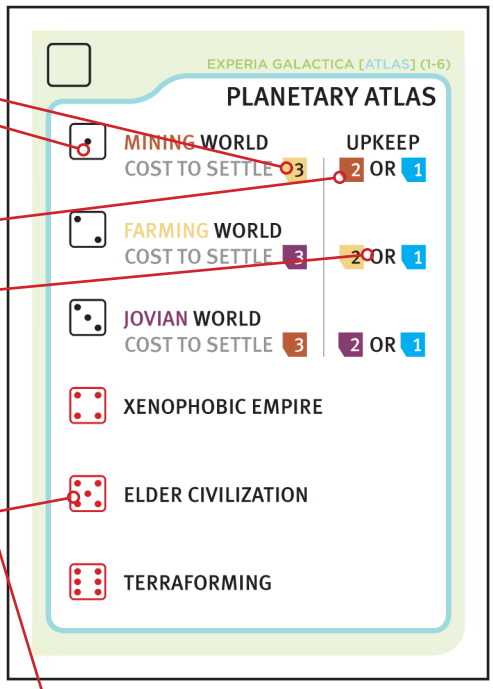
The cost to settle the planet rolled with the die and the resources gained during **Upkeep**.

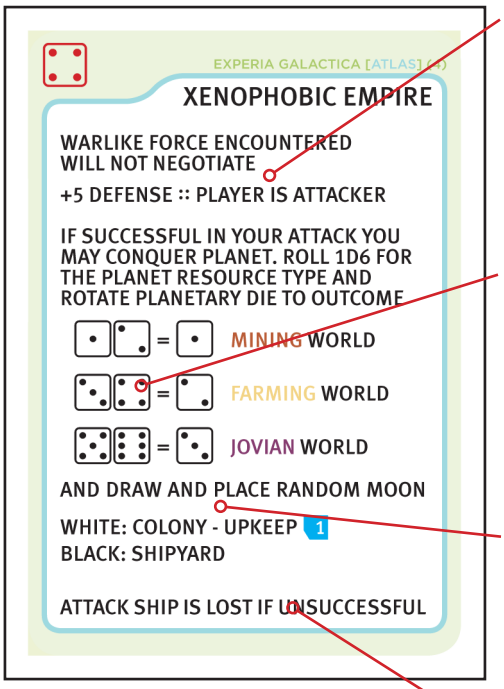
Note: a player may gain Ore, Credit or Energy Resources, **OR** Influence, never both.

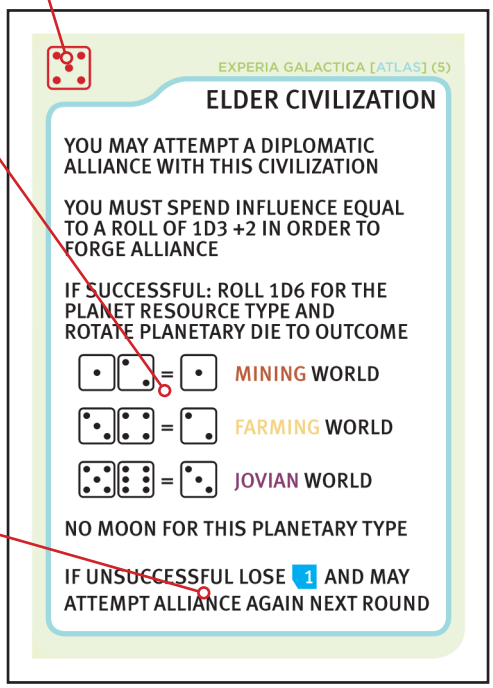
If a ⚂ is rolled, the player encounters an Elder Civilization and may attempt to forge a Diplomatic Alliance by paying Influence Resources equal to 1D3 + 2.

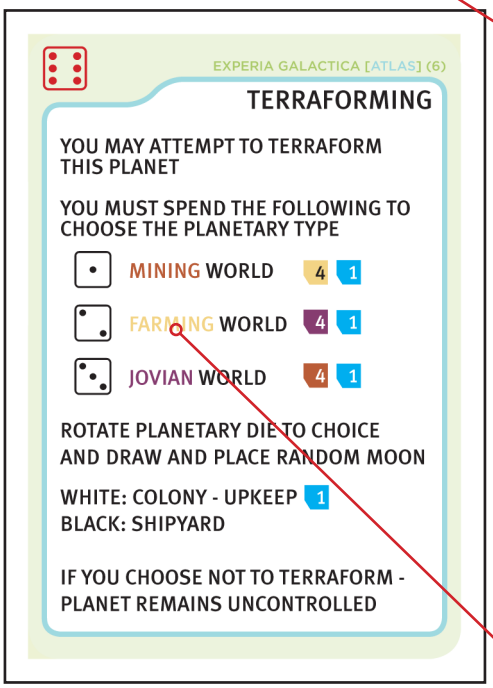
If the player is successful they may roll one die to determine the type of planet they now control (placing a Civilization Marker under the die). They do not have to pay any resources to settle this planet. They will gain resources during **Upkeep**.

If a player is unsuccessful or there is a tie in the roll while forging a Diplomatic Alliance, the planet die is placed with the ⚂ side of the die facing up and the player loses 1 Influence Resource, if they have any. The player's ship remains on the sector. Any player may encounter the Elder Civilization in a later round.









If a ⚃ is rolled, the player encounters a Xenophobic Empire and must attack the planet in Combat. The planet adds a +5 to its die roll for its Defense Strength.

If the player is successful they may roll one die to determine the type of planet they now control (placing a Civilization Marker under the die) and randomly draw a moon. They do not have to pay any resources to settle this planet. They will gain resources during **Upkeep**.

If the player is unsuccessful in their attack, or there is a tie in the roll, the player's ship is lost and the die is placed on the sector with a ⚂ side facing up. In later rounds, players may attempt to Combat again.

If a ⚅ is rolled, the player encounters a planet they may Terraform. The player may spend resources as listed and choose the planetary type they wish to control, placing a Civilization Marker under the die, rotating it to the representative number for that planetary type. The player then randomly draws and places a moon. They will gain resources during **Upkeep** for this planet. If the player does not choose to Terraform, the planet remains uncontrolled and the die is placed on the Sector with the ⚅ side facing up. The player's ship remains on the sector. Any player may Terraform this planet in a later round.

the four phases

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upgrade
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Phase 4: ENCOUNTER - continued

If a ⚅ is rolled the player encounters a planet they may Terraform. The player may spend resources as listed and choose the planetary type they wish to control, placing a Civilization Marker under the die, rotating it to the representative number for that planetary type.

The player will gain resources during **Upkeep** for this planet.

A random cube is drawn (white or black) and placed next to the planet die as a moon. A white cube is a Colony and gives the player one Influence Resource during the **Upkeep** Phase. A black cube is a Shipyard and will allow the player to build ships here, in addition to their Homeworld during the **Upgrade** Phase.

If the player does not choose to Terraform, the planet remains uncontrolled and the die is placed on the Sector with the ⚅ side facing up. The player's ship remains on the sector. Any player may attempt to Terraform this planet in a later round.

Unclaimed Homeworlds in the 2 and 3 player game version may not be encountered.

B. Combat

1. Combat With Other Players' Ships
If a player, during the **Movement** Phase, has placed a ship or ships in a sector already occupied by another player they will be the Attacker and the resident player the Defender. Each player rolls one die as their Attack or Defense Strength and adds their respective Weapon (Attack) or Shield (Defense) number to that, as well as any other bonuses the Civilizations may have.

Further, any additional ship of a player, which is also on the same sector, adds a +1 to the total Attack or Defense Strength of that player. The highest number wins and the player who has lost must remove one of their ships.

When attacking or defending, Combat for each ship is one on one.
[example: Red is the Attacker and has 1 ship, Blue is the Defender and has 2 Ships. If Red wins the first combat then Blue removes one ship and Red will then attack the second Blue Ship].

In the case of a tie, both the Attacker and Defender's ships are removed.

2. Combat With Other Players' Controlled Planets
A player may attack a planet controlled by another player. In this case the controlled planet has a +4 to its die roll for its Defense Strength. Players may place ships on the same sector as a planet they control, conferring an additional +1 to the planet's Defense Strength for each ship there. As with 1. Combat with other player's ships: the player who has lost must remove one of their ships.

A player may never attack another player's Homeworld.

If the attacking player is successful, they replace the previous Civilization marker with one of their own and they now control the planet.

3. Combat with the Xenophobic Empire
If a ⚁ is rolled, the player encounters a Xenophobic Empire and must attack the planet in Combat. The planet adds a +5 to its die roll for its Defense Strength.

If the player is successful they may roll one die to determine the type of planet they now control (placing a Civilization Marker under the die) and randomly draw a moon. They do not have to pay any resources to settle this planet. They will gain resources during **Upkeep**.

If the player is unsuccessful in their attack, or there is a tie in the roll, the player's ship is lost and the die is placed on the sector with a ⚁ side facing up. In later rounds, players may attempt to Combat again.

Winning the Game

The first player to control four Planets at the end of a round's Phase 4 is the winner.

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QUIKGUIDE

The first player to control four Planets at the end of a round's Phase 4 is the winner.

the four phases

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Game Setup

- Each player receives one double-sided Ship Card and Tech Tree Card. Players may choose which ship type they will use in the game.
- Each player receives 15 wooden cubes in their player color and three colored Civilization markers to show which planets are under that player's control.
- Place a wooden cube next to each of the indicated starting resources icons (►).
- Place a wooden cube on each of the initial tech achievements at the top of each Tech Tree column.
- Give a Sector Map Card to each player. They should be oriented depending on the number of players.
- Each player places 2 wooden cubes on their Homeworld as their starting fleet of ships and keeps two more cubes in reserve.
- Each player receives 2 Civilization Cards and may choose one of the Civilizations, discarding the other.
- Place the 10 dice, and 8 white and black cubes within reach of all players.

Rounds and Phases

Phase 1: UPKEEP - Players execute this Phase simultaneously

During this Phase players gain resources from their Homeworld and any Planets and Colony moons they control. They track these accordingly on their Ship and Tech Tree Cards.

Phase 2: UPGRADE - Players execute this Phase simultaneously

During this Phase players may gain new technical achievements by spending the indicated cost in resources shown to the right of the tech achievement. Move the wooden marker on to the newly purchased achievement.

Players may also buy additional ships in this Phase. The cost of a new ship is shown in the upper left of the Ship Card.

Phase 3: MOVEMENT - Players execute this phase in clockwise order beginning with the current Start Player.

Players may now move their ships based on their current level of Engine technology. Players may move as many ships as far as they like as long as they can pay with the Energy Resources. A player may move fewer than the full number of sectors if they choose. Players may only move orthogonally, never diagonally. If a player places a ship on a Spacewarp icon they may place that ship on another Spacewarp icon of their choice one sector clockwise or counterclockwise without spending any extra Energy Resources. To move to another Spacewarp, the player must wait until the next **Movement** Phase.

Phase 4: ENCOUNTER - Players execute this phase in clockwise order beginning with the current Start Player.

A. Encountering an Unknown Planet

Refer to the Encounter Cards for each of the Encounter types. Unclaimed Homeworlds in the 2 and 3 player game version may not be encountered.

B. Combat

1. Combat With Other Players' Ships

   If a player, during the Movement Phase, has placed a ship or ships in a sector already occupied by another player they will be the Attacker and the resident player the Defender. Each player rolls one die as their Attack or Defense Strength and adds their respective Weapon (Attack) or Shield (Defense) number to that, as well as any other bonuses the players' Civilizations may have.

   Further, any additional ship of a player which is also on the same sector adds a +1 to the total Attack or Defense Strength of that player. The highest number wins and the player who has lost must remove one of their ships. When attacking or defending, Combat for each ship is one on one. In the case of a tie, both the Attacker and Defender's ships are removed.

2. Combat With Other Players' Controlled Planets

   A player may attack a planet controlled by another player. In this case the controlled planet has a +4 to its die roll for its Defense Strength. Players may place ships on the same sector as a planet they control, conferring an additional +1 to their Defense Strength for each ship there. A player may never attack another player's Homeworld.

3. Combat with the Xenophobic Empire

   If a 4 is rolled, the player encounters a Xenophobic Empire and must attack the planet in Combat. The planet adds a +5 to its die roll for its Defense Strength. If the player is successful they may roll one die to determine the type of planet they now control (placing a Civilization Marker under the die) and randomly draw a moon. They do not have to pay any resources to settle this planet. They will gain resources during Upkeep.

   If the player is unsuccessful in their attack, or there is a tie in the roll, the player's ship is lost and the die is placed on the sector with a ⚃ side facing up. In later rounds, players may attempt to Combat again.